Management: The safe and sustainable management of biomedical waste is the social and legal responsibilities of people working in healthcare centers.

Waste disposal: Involved by incineration, chemical disinfection, autoclaving, encapsulation, microwave irradiation are methods of waste disposals. Final disposal includes landfill and burying as per norms inside premises.

12.9.4 E-Waste

Electronic waste or e-waste describes discarded electrical electronic devices as well as any refuse created by discarded electronic devices and components and substances involved in their manufacture or use. Their disposal is a growing problem because electronic equipment frequently contains hazardous substances. In a personal computer, for example, there may be lead (Pb) in the cathode ray tube (CRT) and soldering compound, mercury (Hg) in switches and housing, and cobalt (Co) in steel components, among other equally toxic substances. E-wastes are basically PCB (Polychlorinated biphenyl) based, which are non-degradable (**Fig.12.8**).

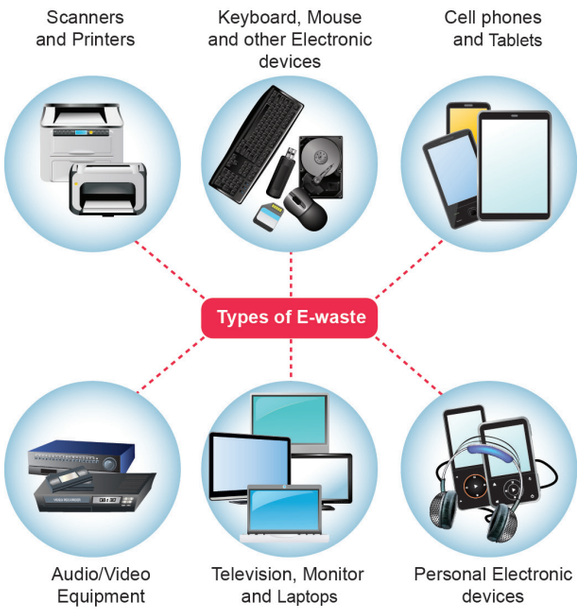


Fig.12.8 Types of E-wastes

Used electronics which are destined for reuse, resale, salvage, recycling, or disposal are also considered e-waste. Unauthorised processing of e-waste in developing countries can lead to adverse human health effects and environmental pollution.

Recycling and disposal of e-waste may involve significant risk to the health of workers and communities in developed countries and great care must be taken to avoid unsafe exposure in recycling operations and leaking of materials such as heavy metals from landfills and incinerator ashes.

12.9.5 Plastic Waste – Solutions and Remedies

Plastics are low molecular weight organic polymers that are non-degradable in the natural environment. They are used in several items, including cars, bulletproof vests, toys, hospital equipment, carry bags and food containers. Packaging materials used in supermarkets, retail outlets, manufacturing industries, households, hotels, hospitals, restaurants and transport companies are major contributors to plastic waste generation. Plastic waste constitutes a major part of municipal solid waste.

- Remedies: '4R'- Refuse, Reduce, Reuse and Recycle mantra is the best available remedy for plastic waste pollution.
- Tamil Nadu State government successfully implemented the ban on single use plastics from 1st January 2019.

12.10 Ecosan Toilets

About 150 liters of wastewater at an average is generated by an Indian individual daily, and a large amount of it is generated from toilets. Ecological sanitation (EcoSan) is a sustainable system for handling human excreta by using dry composting toilets. EcoSan toilets not only reduce wastewater generation but also generate the natural fertilizer from recycled human excreta, which forms an excellent substitute for chemical fertilizers. This

XII Std Biology-Zoology Chapter-12 EM.indd 215 23/12/2022 13:25:17